

Discovering Tut: The Saga Continues

Q1. "The mummy is in very bad condition because of what Carter did in the 1920s."

Who was Carter? What did he do to the mummy?

Answer: Howard Carter was a British archaeologist. He discovered Tut's tomb in 1922 after many years of futile searching. Carter's men removed the mummy's head and cut off almost every major joint to remove the golden adornments.

Q2. Why do you think the royals carried so much gold to grave?

Answer: There were two reasons: first, the royals were extremely wealthy. Secondly, they thought or hoped that they could take their riches with them to the great beyond.

Q3. How has Archaeology undergone change in the twentieth century?

Answer: The change is in two ways: approach and techniques. Now Archaeology focuses less on treasure and more on the fascinating details of life and interesting mysteries of death. Secondly, it uses more sophisticated tools including medical technology.

Q4. How has Tut's mummy fascinated the scientists and commoners alike over the previous decades?

Answer: King Tutankhamun was the last of his family line. His funeral marked the end of a dynasty. He was laid to rest laden with gold as the royals in Tut's time were extremely wealthy and thought they could take their riches with them

His tomb was discovered by Howard Carter, a British archaeologist in 1922, more than 3000 years after his death. The rich royal collection of jeweler and golden artifacts fascinated Carter. Visitors thronged the boy King's tomb. The particulars of King Tut's death and its aftermath are not clear. In 1968, more than 40 years after Carter's discovery, an anatomy Professor X-rayed the mummy. He revealed a startling fact. The breastbone and front ribs of Tut were missing. On 5 January 2005 a CT scan was done to obtain precise data for an accurate forensic reconstruction of King Tut. It was hoped that it would offer new clues about his life and death. Thus Tut's mummy has been the centre of fascination throughout the previous decades.

Q5. Why did Tut's body have to undergo a C.T. scan? How was it carried out and what results did it yield?

Answer: A veil of mystery surrounded Tut's life and death. Old methods of archaeology did not provide satisfactory clues to the circumstances of his death and his age at the time of demise. An X-ray of the mummy in 1968 further complicated the confusion. CT scan was undertaken to create a three dimensional virtual body. A scanner was taken in a trailer to the sandy area near Tut's tomb. Tut's body was carried there from his tomb in a box. The CT machine scanned the mummy head to toe, creating 1700 digital X-ray images in cross section. Tut's entire body was scanned in 0.62 millimetre slices.

The C.T. scan produced clear images of Tut's head, neck vertebrae, ribcage, hand and skull. The results proved satisfactory. A team of specialists in radiology, forensics and anatomy are busy probing the secrets lying buried in Tut's grave with his body.

Q6. Give reasons for the following:
Tut's body was buried along with gilded treasures.

Answer: Tut's body was buried along with gilded treasures because of the belief that their eternal brilliance would guarantee resurrection for the great king. Moreover, the pharaohs of the time were fabulously rich and they believed that they could probably carry their wealth to the other world.

Q7. Give reasons for the following:
The boy king changed his name from Tutankhaten to Tutankhamun. (Textual)

Answer: The boy king changed his name from Tutankhaten to Tutankhamun because he believed himself to be the living image of Amun' the old God of Egyptians and wanted to restore the glory of the old ways.